

Mark Arts – Resume

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Personal Profile

I'm a passionate and curious programmer with a broad skill set looking for a position where I can utilize and learn interesting technologies and tools.

During and after finishing my studies I worked as a backender, grew into a DevOps and eventually became an platform engineer. I am proactive in learning new skills and picking up tasks outside of my function description. Because of this i have frequently contributed to both backend and frontend code. I have worked on multiple high performance applications improving performance, stability and observability. My preference tends to be a supportive role enabling people around me to ship fast and deliver high quality code but I am just as confident architecting and implementing features as designing infrastructure and writing IaC.

As a team member or lead i enjoy providing my teammates opportunities to develop their skills, improving our processes by regular reflection, taking charge of our infrastructure efficiency, security, cost, and reliability, and planning out architectural and implementation details.

Outside of work, I enjoy reading books, music, physical movement, gaming and reading Hacker News.

One of my biggest hobbies is music. It's an outlet for my curiosity, creativity, drive to improve, and playfulness. I'm usually busy with songwriting, playing instruments, mastering songs and everything in between. For a sample of my music check out <https://soundcloud.com/kurkami>

I'm a fast and enthusiastic learner that is always up for a new challenge.

Education

2010-2017 BSc in Media Technology - Rotterdam University of Applied Sciences

Minor in Game Design and Development

Thesis: How can we realize a digital environment in which non-programmers, like 3D modelers and level designers, can build an efficient and unique Virtual Reality experience

2005-2010 Higher General Secondary Education - Emmauscollege, Rotterdam

Employment History

Aug 2024 - now QUATT, Amsterdam Netherlands
Cloud engineer / Principal Platform Engineer

At Quatt I'm responsible for the overall reliability, maintainability, cost and security of our infrastructure. We work with a Platform engineering approach this means we provide capabilities, in the form of tooling and workshops (for example disaster recovery or IaC 101) and golden paths, in the form of documentation and templates to teams. When I joined I started with implementing a proper AWS landing zone and introducing Pulumi and gitops principles for IaC. After that I built out and implemented our strategies for hosting (apprunner and ecs), network topology (tailscale and ipam), observability tooling (sentry/grafana/cloudwatch/axiom) and compliance (AWS Well architected reviews and preventive, detective, and proactive controls). On top of this I work closely with the development teams to improve the codebases where needed with a focus on security and reliability. These tasks range from implementing parallelization and batching of our message processing, reducing our E2E suite from 2 hours to 10min and reducing our clickhouse load by optimizing indexing and observability queries. As part of my role I work closely with both software, data and hardware engineering and frequently weigh in on architectural decisions. With the advent of LLM's I have played a crucial role in the adaption of LLM's outside of code generation by providing knowledge sessions, building tools, defining access policies, controlling cost and giving architectural guidance. This has resulted in reducing triage time for customer support from hours to minutes, virtual hardware rigs allowing us to expand the surface of our E2E testing suites, non programmers (like TAM, Sales, Support. PM's) contributing and even creating new repositories to deploy services matching our quality standards and requirements for code, IaC, security, CI/CD etc.

Technologies: Typescript, Python, Terraform, Pulumi, Flask, Deno, Docker, Nix, AWS, Grafana, Github, Sentry, CI, Axiom, Clickhouse, ECS, Apprunner, SQS, IoT Core, Snowflake, S3, Claude, opentelemetry

May 2017 - Aug 2024 GUTS / GET-protocol, Amsterdam, Netherlands
DevOps / Developer

As the first DevOps engineer at GUTS, I was responsible for the creation and maintenance of the infrastructure of the GUTS ticketing system, which grew from a single Django service to a microservice architecture running on K8s hosted on AWS K8s, implementing modern practices like ArgoCD deployment management, Hub-Spoke private networking, role-based short-lived access tokens through SSO and more. My tasks also included creating and maintaining our internal tooling, including GitLab, GitHub, CI (continuous integration/testing), metric/log aggregation and visualization, error reporting, backups, security, performance, and others. I also took ownership over improving knowledge sharing and code quality across all our disciplines through retros, workshops, hack days, lightning talks, and other activities. Next to my DevOps responsibilities I worked as both Backend and Frontend developer. During my time at GUTS I grew from a junior DevOps to a full-fledged team lead with full responsibility over a modern infrastructure stack.

Technologies: Linux, Python, Go (Golang), Typescript, Ansible, Terraform, ArgoCD, Pulumi, Django, Flask, Deno, Docker, Nix, Vue, AWS, Azure, ELK, Grafana, GitLab, Github, Newrelic, Prometheus, Sentry, CI

Aug 2016 - May 2017 Hoppinger, Rotterdam, Netherlands
DevOps / Developer

After my graduation internship, I returned to working at Hoppinger while finishing my study. In this year, I started focusing more on building automation for DevOps and server management through Puppet.

Technologies: Puppet, Bash, PHP, Ruby, Rails, WordPress, Nix, Docker, Gulp, Linux, Apache, NGINX

Feb 2016 - DPI, Den Haag, Netherlands

Jun 2016 *Graduation Internship*

I researched the possibility for 3D studios to create interactive VR stories without the need for a programmer in the Unreal Engine utilizing its visual scripting system Blueprints.

Technologies: Unreal Engine 4, Blueprints, C++, Virtual Reality

Feb 2013 - Hoppering, Rotterdam, Netherlands

Feb 2016 *Internship / working student*

After my internship at Hoppering I stayed to reinforce the service and support team. As a service and support member I was responsible for the maintenance and small feature requests for Wordpress, Rails and Drupal projects. When I was available full-time, for example vacations, I worked on building bigger projects.

Technologies: PHP, Ruby, Javascript, Sass, Less, Python, Erb, Haml, Wordpress. Ruby on Rails, NodeJS, Puppet, Drupal, Gulp, Drush, Composer, NGINX, Apache, Git, Polymer, React, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch

Jul 2012 - Unitas, Rotterdam, Netherlands

Aug 2012 *Junior Developer*

In the summer after the second year of my bachelor I worked for a company that created a software package to submit import and export request to the dutch customs.

Technologies: WinDev, EDIFACT

Software Engineering Skills

■ Operations

Ansible
Terraform
Pulumi
Docker
Nix(os)
k8s
sops
Argocd
Newrelic
Grafana
Kibana
Cloudwatch
Lambda
EC2
Cloudfront
Cloudflare
Netlify
Stackpath
Hub-Spoke networking with transit gateways
Wireguard
Google admin

■ State management

Couchdb
Postgress
Rabbitmq
Redis
Elasticache
DynamoDB
Prometheus
Elasticsearch
S3

- **Programming Languages in production**

Python
Go
Ruby
HSL (Terraform)
PHP
C++
C#
Javascript
Typescript
Bash/sh - Server scripting / automation

- **Programming Languages in hobby projects**

Elixir
Haskell
Java
Lisp
Lua
Clojure

- **Web Development**

Vue, react-native
GO, Django, Flask, Ruby on Rails, Wordpress, Drupal

Interests

- **Running, Cycling, Yoga, Weight lifting, Cooking, Mental and physical health**
- **Music, Composing, Producing, Sound design, Piano, Accordion, Guitar, Modular Synthesizers**
- **AI, Security, Game development, Blockchain, Hacking, Hacker News**